

SENATE RESOLUTION 396

By Walley

A RESOLUTION to honor Michael Odom upon being named a 2025–2026 Tennessee Distinguished Service Award winner.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this legislative body should recognize those individuals who, through their dedication and professional excellence, have made significant contributions to their communities and to the State of Tennessee; and

WHEREAS, one such individual is Michael Odom, who has been honored as a 2025–2026 Tennessee Distinguished Service Award winner by the Tennessee Secondary School Athletic Association in recognition of his outstanding service to high school athletics and journalism; and

WHEREAS, a native of Jackson and a graduate of North Side High School, Mr. Odom discovered his passion for storytelling during his collegiate years and pursued a career in journalism grounded in a deep care for people and the stories they have to tell; and

WHEREAS, Michael Odom began his career in a supporting role at the *Jackson Sun*, where he answered phones, recorded box scores, and ensured that the accomplishments of young athletes were properly recognized, before advancing to become a high school sports coverage coordinator; and

WHEREAS, over the course of more than two decades, he has distinguished himself as a respected sports journalist, currently serving as sports editor of the *Milan Mirror-Exchange*, where he continues to cover and celebrate high school athletics across West Tennessee communities, including Brownsville, Fayette, and Lexington; and

WHEREAS, through his work, Mr. Odom has chronicled numerous memorable athletic moments, including coverage of Spring Fling and events at Middle Tennessee State University's

"Glass House," while also demonstrating a unique ability to humanize the athletes whose stories he tells; and

WHEREAS, Michael Odom has shown a particular gift for capturing the personal dimensions of sport, as exemplified by his "Faith in Practice" series, which highlights the intersection of athletics and faith in the lives of student athletes and has had a meaningful impact on those whose stories he has shared; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Odom's passion for high school sports and his commitment to telling the stories of Tennessee's young athletes have earned him the respect and admiration of players, coaches, and communities throughout the region; and

WHEREAS, it is wholly fitting that we specially recognize Michael Odom for his dedication to excellence in journalism and his invaluable contributions to the coverage of high school athletics in Tennessee; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, that we honor and commend Michael Odom upon being named a 2025–2026 Tennessee Distinguished Service Award winner by the Tennessee Secondary School Athletic Association and extend to him our best wishes for every continued success.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy.